Create a clear and useful rubric

Assessment

ASSESSMENT ONE-PAGE PRACTICAL GUIDE

WHAT IS THIS FOR?

Build criteria students can understand before submission and staff can use consistently when judging the intended learning.

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Build criteria students can understand before submission and staff can use consistently when judging the intended learning.

WHAT DOES THIS LOOK LIKE?

Criteria describe observable qualities of the intended learning instead of relying on vague labels such as “professional” or “excellent”.

WHAT CAN I DO?

- Start from the learning outcomes, not from inherited rubric categories.
- Use concrete language to describe what quality looks like.
- Remove vague labels such as “professional” unless you define the observable capability.
- Use exemplars or a short walkthrough to show how criteria apply in practice.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A rubric replaces “excellent professional presentation” with specific criteria for audience awareness, structure, evidence and clarity.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For the next teaching period, our team will: start from the learning outcomes, not from inherited rubric categories; use concrete language to describe what quality looks like. We will review student feedback and adjust if needed.

GO FURTHER AT UQ

UQ assessment guidance

Creating and using rubrics

Feedback for learning

Not an approved UQ publication